

Programming in Python for Friends and Relations, Part 13

Creating Rhythmic Noise



Get started with Csound, a powerful musical instrument that's playable from Python.

Over a year ago, when I first tried the OLPC/Sugar software, I was fascinated by the activities in TamTam applications. Had any of them been available in my time, I may even have liked attending school.

The TamTam activity builds on top of the Csound framework to allow children to explore sounds and music. As I explored the Csound tutorial by Michel Gogins, I came across his comment, "Of all the languages I have used, both in my career as a programmer and in my career as an algorithmic composer, Python has been

by far the easiest and most productive language to learn and to use."

Gogins also writes, "Csound must be considered as one of the most powerful musical instruments ever created." Hence, the motivation for this article. We will explore how to create noise and, we hope, you will go on to compose music :-). In the current state of the world, we need even more music.

To know a bit about the people behind the code, go to: www.csounds.com/journal/2006spring/meetTheCsound5Developers.html.